

Tableau Desktop

200+ MCQs with Answers & Explanations

Comprehensive Exam Preparation Guide

*Covers: Desktop Tool, Core Concepts, LOD Expressions,
Table Calculations, Maps, Dashboards, Filters, Parameters & More*

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Section 1: Tableau Basics & Interface

Q1: What is Tableau primarily used for?

- A. Word processing
- B. Data visualization and business intelligence
- C. Spreadsheet calculations
- D. Database management

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau is a leading BI tool designed for creating interactive data visualizations and dashboards.

Q2: Which Tableau product is used for creating and publishing dashboards on a desktop?

- A. Tableau Server
- B. Tableau Online
- C. Tableau Desktop
- D. Tableau Reader

Answer: C

Explanation: Tableau Desktop is the authoring tool used to create workbooks, dashboards, and stories on a local machine.

Q3: What file extension does a Tableau workbook use?

- A. .twb
- B. .twbx
- C. .tde
- D. Both .twb and .twbx

Answer: D

Explanation: .twb is a workbook without data (live connection); .twbx is a packaged workbook with data included.

Q4: What is a Tableau 'Sheet'?

- A. A single data visualization or view
- B. A collection of dashboards
- C. A database table
- D. A PDF export

Answer: A

Explanation: A Sheet is a single view containing a chart, table, or other visualization in Tableau.

Q5: What does the Tableau 'Show Me' feature do?

- A. Suggests chart types based on selected fields
- B. Shows underlying data
- C. Displays a tutorial
- D. Reveals hidden sheets

Answer: A

Explanation: Show Me recommends appropriate visualization types based on the dimensions and measures currently selected in the view.

Q6: Which pane in Tableau lists all the fields from the data source?

- A. Marks card
- B. Filters shelf
- C. Data pane
- D. Analytics pane

Answer: C

Explanation: The Data pane (left sidebar) displays all dimensions, measures, sets, and parameters available from the data source.

Q7: What does the 'Marks' card control in Tableau?

- A. Data source connections
- B. Visual properties like color, size, label, and shape
- C. Filter conditions
- D. Page navigation

Answer: B

Explanation: The Marks card controls how data points are displayed: color, size, label, detail, tooltip, and shape.

Q8: What is a Tableau 'Story'?

- A. A narrative sequence of sheets or dashboards
- B. A single data visualization
- C. A data source description
- D. A calculated field

Answer: A

Explanation: A Story is a collection of sheets/dashboards arranged in sequence to convey a narrative.

Q9: Which toolbar button lets you swap rows and columns?

- A. Sort
- B. Swap
- C. Reset
- D. Undo

Answer: B

Explanation: The Swap button (or Ctrl+W) exchanges fields on the Rows and Columns shelves.

Q10: What happens when you double-click a field in the Data pane?

- A. It opens formatting options
- B. Tableau adds it to the view automatically
- C. It deletes the field
- D. It renames the field

Answer: B

Explanation: Double-clicking a field automatically places it on the appropriate shelf (Rows/Columns) based on whether it's a dimension or measure.

Q11: What does the 'Ctrl + Z' shortcut do in Tableau?

- A. Zoom in
- B. Undo the last action
- C. Close workbook
- D. Show zero lines

Answer: B

Explanation: Ctrl+Z undoes the most recent action in Tableau, similar to most applications.

Q12: What is the purpose of the 'Analytics' pane?

- A. To manage data sources
- B. To add reference lines, trend lines, forecasts, and other analytical objects
- C. To create calculated fields
- D. To edit aliases

Answer: B

Explanation: The Analytics pane provides drag-and-drop analytical objects like trend lines, reference lines, box plots, and forecasts.

Q13: Which Tableau product is free and allows viewing but not editing workbooks?

- A. Tableau Desktop
- B. Tableau Server
- C. Tableau Reader
- D. Tableau Prep

Answer: C

Explanation: Tableau Reader is a free application for viewing and interacting with Tableau workbooks, but it cannot edit or create them.

Q14: What does the 'Fit' option control in a Tableau view?

- A. Data precision
- B. How the visualization scales within the dashboard/view
- C. Filter behavior
- D. Data source refresh rate

Answer: B

Explanation: Fit options (Normal, Fit Width, Fit Height, Entire View) control how a visualization scales within its container.

Q15: What is the 'Status Bar' at the bottom of Tableau Desktop used for?

- A. Displaying error messages only
- B. Showing summary statistics of the view (row count, mark count, etc.)
- C. Chat support
- D. Progress of data extracts

Answer: B

Explanation: The Status Bar displays useful info like number of marks, row counts, and sum/average of selected measures.

Section 2: Data Connections & Data Sources

Q16: Which of the following is NOT a valid data connection type in Tableau?

- A. Excel
- B. SQL Server
- C. Microsoft Word
- D. Google Sheets

Answer: C

Explanation: Tableau cannot directly connect to Word documents. It connects to databases, spreadsheets, cloud services, and web data connectors.

Q17: What is a Tableau Data Extract (.hyper)?

- A. A live connection to a database
- B. A compressed, optimized snapshot of data stored locally
- C. A type of calculated field
- D. A PDF export

Answer: B

Explanation: A .hyper extract is a high-performance in-memory data snapshot optimized for fast querying in Tableau.

Q18: What is the difference between a Live connection and an Extract?

- A. There is no difference
- B. Live queries the source in real-time; Extract is a static snapshot
- C. Live is faster; Extract is slower
- D. Extract only works with Excel

Answer: B

Explanation: A Live connection queries the data source every time the view changes, while an Extract is a pre-loaded snapshot that works offline and is often faster.

Q19: How do you combine data from multiple tables in the SAME database?

- A. Blending
- B. Joining
- C. Union
- D. Cross-database filter

Answer: B

Explanation: Joins combine tables from the same data source/connection using a common field. Blending is for different data sources.

Q20: What is Data Blending in Tableau?

- A. Merging two extracts
- B. Combining data from separate data sources at an aggregate level
- C. Creating a union
- D. Removing duplicates

Answer: B

Explanation: Data blending combines data from different sources by linking on common dimensions, with one primary and one or more secondary sources.

Q21: Which join type returns all records from the left table and matching records from the right table?

- A. Inner Join
- B. Right Join
- C. Left Join
- D. Full Outer Join

Answer: C

Explanation: A Left Join returns all rows from the left table plus matching rows from the right table; non-matching right rows appear as NULL.

Q22: What does a Union do in Tableau?

- A. Joins tables on a key
- B. Appends rows from multiple tables with the same structure
- C. Creates a relationship
- D. Merges fields

Answer: B

Explanation: A Union stacks rows from tables with the same column structure, effectively appending data vertically.

Q23: What is the purpose of the Data Interpreter in Tableau?

- A. Translates data to other languages
- B. Cleans and reshapes messy Excel/CSV data automatically
- C. Explains the data model
- D. Converts data types

Answer: B

Explanation: Data Interpreter detects and cleans sub-tables, extra headers, and formatting issues in spreadsheets before import.

Q24: You can connect Tableau to which type of file?

- A. Only Excel
- B. Only CSV
- C. Excel, CSV, PDF, JSON, and more
- D. Only database files

Answer: C

Explanation: Tableau supports numerous file types including Excel, CSV, PDF, JSON, spatial files, text files, and more.

Q25: What is a 'Relationship' in Tableau's data model (introduced in 2020.2+)?

- A. A type of join
- B. A semantic layer combining tables without specifying join types upfront
- C. A filter condition
- D. A calculated field

Answer: B

Explanation: Relationships define how tables relate logically; Tableau auto-selects appropriate joins at query time based on the viz.

Q26: Which data role is assigned to geographic fields like City or Country?

- A. Measure
- B. Calculated field
- C. Geographic role
- D. Parameter

Answer: C

Explanation: Geographic roles (Country, City, Zip Code, etc.) tell Tableau to treat a field as spatial data for mapping.

Q27: What does 'Extract Filters' do?

- A. Filters rows when creating a data extract
- B. Filters the view only
- C. Filters the dashboard
- D. Removes duplicates from extract

Answer: A

Explanation: Extract filters limit which rows are included in a .hyper extract, reducing extract size and improving performance.

Q28: Can Tableau connect to multiple data sources in a single workbook?

- A. No, only one
- B. Yes, multiple connections supported
- C. Only with Tableau Server
- D. Only databases

Answer: B

Explanation: A single Tableau workbook can contain multiple data source connections; sheets use one source, dashboards can blend.

Q29: What is Tableau Prep used for?

- A. Creating visualizations
- B. Data preparation, cleaning, and shaping before analysis
- C. Publishing dashboards
- D. Running SQL queries

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Prep is a separate tool for cleaning, combining, and reshaping data before using it in Tableau Desktop.

Q30: What is the default aggregation for measures in Tableau?

- A. SUM
- B. AVG
- C. COUNT
- D. MIN

Answer: A

Explanation: By default, Tableau aggregates measures using SUM when they are placed in the view.

Q31: How do you change a field's data type in Tableau?

- A. Right-click the field and choose 'Change Data Type'
- B. Use a calculated field
- C. Edit in the data source tab by clicking the type icon
- D. Both A and C

Answer: D

Explanation: You can change a data type by right-clicking in the Data pane or clicking the data type icon in the Data Source tab.

Q32: What does 'Replace References' do in Tableau?

- A. Replaces text in tooltips
- B. Replaces one field with another across the entire workbook
- C. Replaces data sources
- D. Replaces file paths

Answer: B

Explanation: Replace References lets you swap all occurrences of a field (including in calculations) with another field throughout the workbook.

Section 3: Dimensions & Measures

Q33: In Tableau, a 'Dimension' is typically:

- A. A numeric value that can be aggregated
- B. A categorical or qualitative field used to slice data
- C. A calculated field only
- D. A type of filter

Answer: B

Explanation: Dimensions are qualitative/categorical fields (e.g., Region, Product Category) used to group and segment data.

Q34: What color represents continuous fields in Tableau?

- A. Blue
- B. Green
- C. Red
- D. Yellow

Answer: B

Explanation: Continuous fields are displayed in green pills; they represent an unbroken range of values along an axis.

Q35: What color represents discrete fields in Tableau?

- A. Blue
- B. Green
- C. Red
- D. Yellow

Answer: A

Explanation: Discrete fields are displayed in blue pills; they create headers/categories rather than continuous axes.

Q36: Which of the following is treated as a MEASURE by default?

- A. Customer Name
- B. Order Date
- C. Sales Amount
- D. Region

Answer: C

Explanation: Numeric fields that can be aggregated (like Sales, Profit, Quantity) are classified as measures by default.

Q37: How can you convert a measure to a dimension?

- A. It cannot be done
- B. Drag it to the Dimensions pane or use the dropdown
- C. Use a calculation
- D. Only through data source changes

Answer: B

Explanation: In Tableau, you can move a measure to dimensions by dragging it there or changing it via the right-click context menu.

Q38: What does the 'Measure Names' field do?

- A. Lists all measure field names in the data source
- B. Calculates name lengths
- C. Renames measures
- D. Filters measures

Answer: A

Explanation: Measure Names is a special field containing the names of all measures, useful for creating measure-switching views.

Q39: What does the 'Measure Values' field contain?

- A. All dimension values
- B. The aggregated values of measures in the view
- C. String values only
- D. Unique identifiers

Answer: B

Explanation: Measure Values holds the actual aggregated values of measures placed on the Measure Values card.

Q40: If 'Profit' appears green on the Rows shelf, it means:

- A. Profit is a dimension
- B. Profit is being treated as continuous (axis)
- C. Profit is discrete
- D. Profit is filtered

Answer: B

Explanation: Green pills indicate continuous fields that form an axis. Blue pills indicate discrete fields that form headers.

Q41: How does Tableau decide if a numeric field is a dimension or measure?

- A. All numeric fields are measures
- B. Tableau uses heuristics (unique vs. aggregatable); user can override
- C. Numeric fields with fewer distinct values become dimensions
- D. It's random

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau automatically classifies fields, but users can freely convert between dimension and measure as needed.

Q42: What happens when you place a discrete date field on Columns?

- A. It creates a continuous timeline
- B. It creates discrete date headers/panes
- C. It creates a scatter plot
- D. It errors out

Answer: B

Explanation: Discrete date parts (e.g., YEAR(Order Date)) create separate headers/panes rather than a continuous axis.

Q43: The 'Number of Records' field represents:

- A. A dimension
- B. An auto-generated measure counting all rows in the data
- C. A parameter
- D. A custom calculation

Answer: B

Explanation: Number of Records is an auto-generated measure that counts every row at the current level of detail.

Q44: Which shelf would you use to split a view into multiple horizontal panels by a dimension?

- A. Columns
- B. Rows
- C. Pages
- D. Filters

Answer: B

Explanation: Placing a discrete dimension on the Rows shelf creates horizontal panels/rows of sub-views for each dimension value.

Q45: What is a 'hierarchy' in Tableau?

- A. A set
- B. A drill-down structure organizing related dimensions (e.g., Country > State > City)
- C. A type of calculation
- D. A filter type

Answer: B

Explanation: Hierarchies allow drilling down through related dimensions (e.g., Category > Sub-Category > Product Name).

Q46: You can create a hierarchy by:

- A. Dragging one dimension onto another in the Data pane
- B. Using a calculated field
- C. Using the Analytics pane
- D. It cannot be manually created

Answer: A

Explanation: Simply drag a dimension onto another related dimension in the Data pane to create a drillable hierarchy.

Q47: What does 'Attribute' aggregation do?

- A. Calculates average
- B. Returns the value if it is unique for the partition; returns * if multiple values exist
- C. Sums values
- D. Counts values

Answer: B

Explanation: ATTR() returns the dimension value if only one exists in the context; otherwise displays an asterisk ().*

Section 4: Charts & Visualizations

Q48: Which chart type is best for showing the distribution of a single measure?

- A. Line chart
- B. Histogram
- C. Map
- D. Text table

Answer: B

Explanation: Histograms (created via bins) show the frequency distribution of a continuous measure across intervals.

Q49: To create a bar chart, what is the minimum requirement?

- A. 2 measures
- B. 1 dimension + 1 measure
- C. 2 dimensions
- D. 1 measure only

Answer: B

Explanation: A basic bar chart needs at least one dimension (categories) and one measure (bar length).

Q50: How do you create a dual-axis chart in Tableau?

- A. Use Show Me
- B. Right-click a measure pill and select 'Dual Axis'
- C. Drag two measures to the same axis and choose Dual Axis
- D. Both B and C

Answer: D

Explanation: You can create a dual-axis chart by right-clicking a second measure's pill and choosing Dual Axis, or by dragging it onto the existing axis.

Q51: What is a 'Combination Chart' in Tableau?

- A. A chart with two dimensions
- B. A chart with multiple mark types on the same view (e.g., bars + lines)
- C. A chart merged from two data sources
- D. A set of multiple sheets

Answer: B

Explanation: Combination charts use different mark types (bar, line, circle, etc.) for different measures on the same view, often via dual axes.

Q52: A scatter plot requires at least:

- A. 2 measures and 0 dimensions
- B. 2 measures and 1 dimension (Detail)
- C. 1 measure and 1 dimension
- D. 3 measures

Answer: A

Explanation: A scatter plot maps two measures against each other (one on each axis); a dimension on Detail adds individual points.

Q53: How do you add a trend line in Tableau?

- A. Use the Analytics pane and drag Trend Line onto the view
- B. Right-click the visualization
- C. Use a calculated field
- D. Not possible in Tableau

Answer: A

Explanation: Trend lines are added via the Analytics pane by dragging the Trend Line object onto an eligible visualization.

Q54: What is a 'Pareto Chart'?

- A. A stacked bar chart
- B. A combination of bars (descending) and a cumulative percentage line
- C. A type of pie chart
- D. A map visualization

Answer: B

Explanation: A Pareto chart combines descending bars (individual contributions) with a cumulative percentage line, highlighting the 80/20 rule.

Q55: What is a 'Heat Map' in Tableau?

- A. A map with temperature data
- B. A crosstab where cell color intensity represents a measure's value
- C. A type of bar chart
- D. A chart showing weather patterns

Answer: B

Explanation: Heat maps encode a measure as color intensity within a grid (crosstab) formed by two dimensions.

Q56: How do you create a calculated bin in Tableau?

- A. Right-click a measure and choose Create > Bins
- B. Use a calculated field with IF statements
- C. Use the Analytics pane
- D. Not possible

Answer: A

Explanation: Right-click a continuous measure and choose Create > Bins to define equal-sized intervals for histogram creation.

Q57: What is a 'Treemap'?

- A. A map of trees
- B. A visualization using nested rectangles sized and colored by measures
- C. A hierarchical bar chart
- D. A type of line chart

Answer: B

Explanation: Treemaps display hierarchical data as nested rectangles, with size representing one measure and color another.

Q58: Which chart is best for showing the composition of a whole across categories?

- A. Scatter plot
- B. Line chart
- C. Pie chart or Stacked bar chart
- D. Histogram

Answer: C

Explanation: Pie charts and stacked bar charts effectively show how parts contribute to the whole (100%).

Q59: How do you add reference lines?

- A. Right-click the axis
- B. Drag from the Analytics pane
- C. Use the Format menu
- D. Both A and B

Answer: D

Explanation: Reference lines can be added via the Analytics pane (dragging) or by right-clicking an axis and selecting 'Add Reference Line'.

Q60: What is a 'Bullet Graph'?

- A. A chart with bullet points
- B. A variation of a bar chart comparing actual vs. target with qualitative ranges
- C. A type of scatter plot
- D. A chart showing bullet trajectory

Answer: B

Explanation: Bullet graphs show progress toward a target, with qualitative performance ranges in the background.

Q61: What is 'Gantt Chart' typically used for?

- A. Showing geographic data
- B. Showing project timelines and duration over time
- C. Showing distribution
- D. Showing part-to-whole relationships

Answer: B

Explanation: Gantt charts display duration of events or tasks over time, commonly used in project management.

Q62: Which chart type uses the 'Path' mark type in Tableau?

- A. Pie chart
- B. Gantt chart
- C. Line chart on maps (origin-destination)
- D. Bar chart

Answer: C

Explanation: The Path mark type connects points in order, useful for origin-destination maps and flight paths.

Q63: How do you display data labels on a chart?

- A. Drag 'Label' from the Marks card dropdown
- B. Right-click and choose 'Annotate'
- C. Use a calculated field
- D. Labels are always shown

Answer: A

Explanation: You can show/hide labels by toggling the Label button on the Marks card or dragging a field to the Label shelf.

Q64: What is a 'Waterfall Chart'?

- A. A chart showing flowing water
- B. A chart showing cumulative effect of sequential positive/negative values
- C. A type of map
- D. A dual-axis chart

Answer: B

Explanation: Waterfall charts display how an initial value changes through a series of positive and negative contributions.

Q65: What is a 'Box-and-Whisker Plot' used for?

- A. Showing geographic distribution
- B. Displaying statistical distribution (quartiles, median, outliers)
- C. Showing time series
- D. Showing part-to-whole

Answer: B

Explanation: Box plots summarize data distribution through quartiles (Q1, median, Q3) and identify outliers via whiskers.

Q66: How do you create a 'Donut Chart' in Tableau?

- A. Use Show Me
- B. Create a pie chart and overlay a white circle using dual axis
- C. Use the Analytics pane
- D. Donut charts aren't supported

Answer: B

Explanation: Donut charts are created by making a pie chart, then using a dual axis with a smaller white circle or a calculated field.

Q67: What is a 'Highlight Table'?

- A. A text table with no color
- B. A crosstab where cell background color reflects a measure's magnitude
- C. A table showing only highlighted rows
- D. A filtered table

Answer: B

Explanation: Highlight tables are text tables (crosstabs) enhanced with color to emphasize relative values across cells.

Q68: What does the 'Sparkline' visualization do?

- A. Shows sparks
- B. Displays a small trend line without axes for rapid comparison
- C. Creates large charts
- D. Shows geographic data

Answer: B

Explanation: Sparklines are compact, word-sized line charts showing trends, often used in text tables for quick comparison.

Q69: Which mark type is best for showing density or concentration?

- A. Bar
- B. Line
- C. Density mark (or Circle with transparency)
- D. Shape

Answer: C

Explanation: Density marks or semi-transparent circles reveal where data points concentrate, useful for identifying clusters.

Q70: How do you swap a chart's rows and columns?

- A. Ctrl + W
- B. Drag fields manually
- C. Click the Swap button in the toolbar
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: You can swap rows and columns via Ctrl+W, the Swap toolbar button, or manually dragging fields between shelves.

Q71: What does the 'Stack Marks' option do?

- A. Deletes marks
- B. Stacks bar segments on top of each other instead of side-by-side
- C. Sorts marks alphabetically
- D. Nothing

Answer: B

Explanation: Stack Marks switches from grouped side-by-side bars to stacked bars where segments accumulate vertically.

Section 5: Filters & Sorting

Q72: What is the order of operations for Tableau filters?

- A. Extract > Data Source > Context > Dimension > Measure
- B. Data Source > Extract > Dimension > Context > Measure
- C. Context > Extract > Data Source > Measure > Dimension
- D. All filters apply simultaneously

Answer: A

Explanation: Filter order: Extract Filters > Data Source Filters > Context Filters > Dimension Filters > Measure Filters > Table Calc Filters.

Q73: What is a 'Context Filter' in Tableau?

- A. A filter applied to the entire workbook
- B. A filter that creates a temporary table for other filters to reference
- C. A filter on dashboards only
- D. A date filter

Answer: B

Explanation: Context filters execute first among worksheet filters, creating a reduced dataset that subsequent filters operate on.

Q74: How do you make a filter apply to multiple sheets?

- A. Use a parameter
- B. Right-click the filter and choose 'Apply to Worksheets' > 'Selected Worksheets'
- C. Copy-paste the filter
- D. This isn't possible

Answer: B

Explanation: You can apply a filter to multiple sheets by right-clicking, selecting 'Apply to Worksheets', and choosing target sheets.

Q75: What types of filters exist in Tableau? (Select the most complete)

- A. Only quick filters
- B. Extract, Data Source, Context, Dimension, Measure, Table Calc
- C. Only dimension filters
- D. Only measure filters

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau's filtering hierarchy includes: Extract, Data Source, Context, Dimension (discrete), Measure (aggregate), and Table Calculation filters.

Q76: What is a 'Quick Filter'?

- A. A filter that works faster
- B. A filter exposed on the view/dashboard for user interaction
- C. A filter applied to extracts
- D. A filter using SQL

Answer: B

Explanation: Quick filters (now called 'Filters' shown on the view) allow end users to interactively filter the visualization.

Q77: What is the 'Top N' filter used for?

- A. Filtering by date
- B. Showing only the top or bottom N values based on a measure
- C. Filtering text alphabetically
- D. Removing NULLs

Answer: B

Explanation: Top N filters limit the view to the highest (or lowest) N members of a dimension, ranked by a specified measure.

Q78: How do you sort a bar chart in descending order?

- A. Click the descending sort button on the toolbar
- B. Right-click the dimension header and choose Sort
- C. Drag bars manually
- D. Both A and B

Answer: D

Explanation: You can sort by clicking the sort toolbar buttons or by right-clicking a dimension header/pill to access Sort options.

Q79: What is a 'Computed Sort' vs. 'Manual Sort'?

- A. No difference
- B. Computed sorts based on data values; Manual sorts use drag-and-drop arrangement
- C. Computed uses formulas; Manual uses SQL
- D. Computed is faster

Answer: B

Explanation: Computed sorting orders values by data/measure/alphabetic rules; Manual sorting lets users freely arrange items by dragging.

Q80: What happens when you add a dimension filter before a context filter?

- A. Nothing special
- B. The dimension filter works on the full dataset; context filters always evaluate first
- C. Error occurs
- D. The filter is ignored

Answer: B

Explanation: Context filters always evaluate before regular dimension filters, regardless of the order they were created.

Q81: What is a 'Data Source Filter'?

- A. A filter applied in the Data Source tab, limiting all worksheets
- B. A filter on the view
- C. A filter on a dashboard
- D. An extract filter

Answer: A

Explanation: Data Source Filters are set at the connection level and restrict data for all worksheets using that data source.

Q82: How do you create a filter that changes based on another filter's selection?

- A. Use a parameter
- B. Select 'Only Relevant Values' in the filter options
- C. Use a calculated field
- D. Both B and C

Answer: D

Explanation: The 'Only Relevant Values' option auto-filters to show valid choices; calculated fields with filter logic can also achieve cascading filters.

Q83: What is the difference between 'Exclude' and 'Keep Only' in a filter?

- A. No difference
- B. Exclude removes selected items; Keep Only retains only the selected items
- C. Exclude is permanent; Keep Only is temporary
- D. Exclude works on measures only

Answer: B

Explanation: Exclude removes specific members from the view; Keep Only removes everything except the selected members.

Q84: What happens if you apply a Measure Filter (e.g., SUM(Sales) > 1000)?

- A. It filters dimensions
- B. It filters after aggregation, removing aggregated values below the threshold
- C. It filters before aggregation
- D. It doesn't work

Answer: B

Explanation: Measure filters apply after measures are aggregated, filtering out aggregates that don't meet the condition.

Q85: How do wildcard filters work in Tableau?

- A. They use SQL LIKE patterns
- B. They match dimension values using Contains, Starts With, Ends With, or Exact Match
- C. They filter by measure values
- D. They only work on numbers

Answer: B

Explanation: Wildcard filters match dimension text values based on patterns: Contains, Starts With, Ends With, or Exact Match.

Q86: What is the 'Filter Shelf'?

- A. A physical shelf
- B. The area above the view where filter pills are placed
- C. A data storage area
- D. The Marks card

Answer: B

Explanation: The Filters shelf holds all filter pills applied to the current worksheet view.

Q87: Can you set a default value for a quick filter?

- A. No
- B. Yes, through filter settings/customization
- C. Only on Tableau Server
- D. Only for date filters

Answer: B

Explanation: You can set default filter values through the filter dropdown > 'Customize' > checking 'Show default value' or via dashboard actions.

Q88: What is the purpose of 'Filter Actions' on a dashboard?

- A. To filter the data source
- B. To use selection in one sheet as a filter for other sheets on the dashboard
- C. To delete data
- D. To change chart colors

Answer: B

Explanation: Filter actions let users click/hover/select marks in one worksheet to filter the data shown in other dashboard worksheets.

Q89: Which filter type does NOT appear as a filter card/quick filter on the view?

- A. Dimension filter
- B. Extract filter
- C. Measure filter
- D. Table Calc filter

Answer: B

Explanation: Extract filters are applied during extract creation and don't appear as interactive filter cards on the view.

Q90: What is 'Show Filter' option used for?

- A. To display a filter as an interactive control on the view/dashboard
- B. To debug filter performance
- C. To show the filter SQL
- D. To print filters

Answer: A

Explanation: Right-clicking a filter pill and choosing 'Show Filter' displays it as an interactive UI element for end users.

Q91: In filter hierarchy, which filter type is applied LAST?

- A. Extract filters
- B. Data Source filters
- C. Context filters
- D. Table Calculation filters

Answer: D

Explanation: Table Calculation filters are applied last, after all other filters, because table calcs compute on the already-filtered result set.

Q92: What does the 'Add to Context' right-click option do to a dimension filter?

- A. Deletes it
- B. Makes it a context filter (evaluated before other dimension filters)
- C. Converts it to a measure filter
- D. Applies it to all sheets

Answer: B

Explanation: Promoting a dimension filter to context makes it execute earlier in the filter pipeline, creating a temporary reduced table.

Q93: How do you sort by a measure that isn't in the view?

- A. Not possible
- B. Use the Sort dialog and select a field from the dropdown
- C. Use a table calculation
- D. Create a parameter

Answer: B

Explanation: The Sort dialog allows you to sort a dimension by any measure in the data source, even if it's not visible.

Q94: What does 'Group by' option in sorting do?

- A. Creates groups
- B. Specifies the level at which sorting is computed (e.g., sort each pane independently)
- C. Groups all values together
- D. Creates a set

Answer: B

Explanation: Nested sorting with 'Group by' sorts within each partition/group independently rather than across the entire view.

Section 6: Calculated Fields & Functions

Q95: What are the three main types of calculated fields in Tableau?

- A. Basic, Advanced, Expert
- B. Row-level, Aggregate, Table Calculations
- C. Text, Number, Date
- D. Simple, Complex, Nested

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau calculations fall into: Row-Level (e.g., IF/THEN), Aggregate (SUM, AVG), and Table Calculations (computed on results).

Q96: Which function returns the total sum of a field?

- A. COUNT()
- B. SUM()
- C. TOTAL()
- D. AVG()

Answer: B

Explanation: SUM() is the primary aggregate function that returns the arithmetic sum of all values in a measure.

Q97: What does the IIF() function do?

- A. Evaluates a condition and returns one of two values (inline IF)
- B. Counts items
- C. Converts to integer
- D. Finds the index of an item

Answer: A

Explanation: IIF(condition, true_value, false_value) is a shorthand for IF-THEN-ELSE returning one of two results.

Q98: What is the difference between IF and CASE statements?

- A. No difference
- B. IF evaluates boolean conditions; CASE matches a single expression against multiple values
- C. CASE is faster; IF is slower
- D. IF works on strings; CASE on numbers

Answer: B

Explanation: IF evaluates complex boolean logic; CASE matches one expression against discrete values (cleaner for equality checks).

Q99: What does the ZN() function do?

- A. Converts values to zero
- B. Returns the expression if not NULL; returns 0 if NULL
- C. Zips numbers
- D. Calculates z-score

Answer: B

Explanation: ZN() (Zero Null) replaces NULL values with zero, useful for preventing NULL propagation in calculations.

Q100: What does the DATEDIFF() function return?

- A. A date
- B. The difference between two dates in specified units (day, month, year, etc.)
- C. A boolean
- D. A formatted string

Answer: B

Explanation: DATEDIFF('day', start_date, end_date) returns the difference between dates in the specified date part.

Q101: What is the CONTAINS() function used for?

- A. Checking if a string contains a substring
- B. Checking if an array contains a value
- C. Checking if a database contains a table
- D. Adding items to a set

Answer: A

Explanation: CONTAINS(string, substring) returns TRUE if the substring is found anywhere in the string field.

Q102: What does the LEFT() string function do?

- A. Aligns text left
- B. Returns the leftmost N characters of a string
- C. Removes left spaces
- D. Joins strings from left

Answer: B

Explanation: LEFT(string, num_chars) extracts the first N characters from the left side of a string.

Q103: What is a 'Row-Level Calculation'?

- A. A calculation that operates on each row of data individually
- B. A calculation that aggregates data
- C. A table calculation
- D. A parameter

Answer: A

Explanation: Row-level calculations (e.g., IF [Sales] > 1000 THEN 'High' END) evaluate for each row before aggregation.

Q104: Which function would you use to calculate year-over-year growth?

- A. SUM()
- B. LOOKUP()
- C. (Current Year - Prior Year) / Prior Year
- D. AVG()

Answer: C

Explanation: YoY growth = (SUM(current) - SUM(prior)) / SUM(prior); often combined with table calculations like LOOKUP or window functions.

Q105: What does the ABS() function do?

- A. Returns the absolute (positive) value of a number
- B. Returns the abbreviation
- C. Abstracts a value
- D. Absorbs values

Answer: A

Explanation: ABS(-5) returns 5; it converts any number to its positive magnitude.

Q106: How do you create a calculated field in Tableau?

- A. Right-click in Data pane > Create Calculated Field
- B. From Analysis menu > Create Calculated Field
- C. Both A and B
- D. It can only be done in SQL

Answer: C

Explanation: Calculated fields can be created via right-click in Data pane or through the Analysis menu.

Q107: What does the COUNTD() function do?

- A. Counts all records
- B. Counts distinct (unique) values of a field
- C. Counts dimensions
- D. Counts dates

Answer: B

Explanation: COUNTD([Customer ID]) returns the number of unique customer IDs, ignoring duplicates.

Q108: Which date function extracts the month from a date?

- A. MONTH()
- B. DATE()
- C. DAY()
- D. YEAR()

Answer: A

Explanation: MONTH([Order Date]) returns the month number (1-12) from a date field.

Q109: What is the purpose of the MAKEDATE() function?

- A. Creates a date from year, month, day components
- B. Formats a date as string
- C. Calculates date difference
- D. Returns today's date

Answer: A

Explanation: MAKEDATE(2024, 12, 25) constructs a date value from integer year, month, and day arguments.

Q110: What does the STR() function do?

- A. Converts a number to a string
- B. Stretches text
- C. Builds structures
- D. Streamlines data

Answer: A

Explanation: STR(123) returns '123'; it converts numeric values to their string representation.

Q111: What is the difference between SUM() and TOTAL()?

- A. No difference
- B. SUM is a standard aggregate; TOTAL() is a table calculation summing across the entire table/partition
- C. SUM works on measures; TOTAL on dimensions
- D. TOTAL is faster

Answer: B

Explanation: SUM() is an aggregate function; TOTAL() is a table calculation that sums across the entire result set or partition.

Q112: What does the REGEXP_MATCH() function do?

- A. Matches strings exactly
- B. Performs regular expression pattern matching on strings
- C. Matches record IDs
- D. Matches file names

Answer: B

Explanation: REGEXP_MATCH(string, pattern) returns TRUE if the string matches the given regular expression pattern.

Q113: How do you handle division by zero in a calculated field?

- A. Use IFERROR()
- B. Check denominator with IF [denom] != 0 THEN ... END
- C. Use ZN()
- D. Both B and C can work

Answer: D

Explanation: You can prevent div/0 by checking the denominator (IF [Sales] != 0 THEN [Profit]/[Sales] END) or using ZN.

Q114: What does the MIN() function return for a string field?

- A. Error
- B. The alphabetically first (minimum) string value
- C. The shortest string
- D. Zero

Answer: B

Explanation: MIN() on strings returns the lexicographically smallest (alphabetically first) value in the dataset.

Q115: What is the function to get the current date in Tableau?

- A. NOW()
- B. TODAY()
- C. CURRENT_DATE()
- D. Both B and C

Answer: D

Explanation: TODAY() returns the current date; NOW() returns current date+time. Both can be used for today's date.

Q116: What does the SPLIT() function do?

- A. Splits a string into parts based on a delimiter and returns a specified token
- B. Divides numbers
- C. Splits data sources
- D. Separates dashboards

Answer: A

Explanation: SPLIT('A,B,C', ',', 2) returns 'B' - it tokenizes a string by delimiter and returns the Nth token.

Q117: What is the purpose of the INDEX() table calculation?

- A. Returns the database index
- B. Returns the row number (1-based) in the current partition
- C. Indexes fields for performance
- D. Creates an index on a column

Answer: B

Explanation: INDEX() is a table calculation returning 1 for the first row, 2 for the second, etc., within each partition.

Q118: What does the WINDOW_SUM() function do?

- A. Sums all data
- B. Calculates a running sum
- C. Sums values within a defined window/range of the table
- D. Sums only visible values

Answer: C

Explanation: WINDOW_SUM(SUM([Sales]), -2, 0) sums the measure across a sliding window of rows relative to the current row.

Q119: What is a 'Boolean' calculated field?

- A. A field returning TRUE or FALSE
- B. A field returning numbers
- C. A field returning dates
- D. A field returning text

Answer: A

Explanation: Boolean fields evaluate to TRUE/FALSE and are commonly used as filters (e.g., [Profit] > 0 returns TRUE or FALSE).

Q120: What does the FLOAT() function do?

- A. Converts a value to a floating-point number
- B. Makes things float in the view
- C. Creates floating dashboard objects
- D. Rounds numbers

Answer: A

Explanation: FLOAT('3.14') converts a string or integer to a floating-point (decimal) number.

Q121: What is MAX() used for with date fields?

- A. Returns the most recent date
- B. Returns the earliest date
- C. Counts days between dates
- D. Not applicable

Answer: A

Explanation: MAX([Order Date]) returns the latest/most recent date in the dataset or partition.

Q122: How do you concatenate strings in Tableau?

- A. Using CONCAT()
- B. Using the + operator
- C. Using the || operator
- D. Using the & operator

Answer: B

Explanation: In Tableau, strings are concatenated using the + operator: 'Hello ' + 'World' returns 'Hello World'.

Q123: What does the ROUND() function do?

- A. Makes a shape round
- B. Rounds a number to a specified number of decimal places
- C. Rounds text to nearest word
- D. Creates circular charts

Answer: B

Explanation: ROUND(3.14159, 2) returns 3.14; it rounds a number to the specified decimal precision.

Section 7: Parameters

Q124: What is a parameter in Tableau?

- A. A type of filter
- B. A dynamic, user-defined input that can replace constant values in calculations and filters
- C. A data source connection
- D. A chart type

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters are workbook variables that allow users to dynamically change values used in calculations, filters, and reference lines.

Q125: Which of the following can a parameter control?

- A. Bin size
- B. Top N value
- C. Reference line value
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: Parameters can control virtually any input: bin sizes, Top N thresholds, reference lines, calculated field values, and more.

Q126: How do you create a parameter?

- A. Right-click in Data pane > Create Parameter
- B. Analysis menu > Create Parameter
- C. Both A and B
- D. Only via a calculated field

Answer: C

Explanation: Parameters can be created by right-clicking in the Data pane or via the Analysis menu.

Q127: What data types can a parameter have?

- A. String only
- B. Integer only
- C. Integer, Float, String, Date, Boolean
- D. Only Boolean

Answer: C

Explanation: Parameters support Integer, Float (decimal), String, Date, and Boolean data types.

Q128: How is a parameter different from a filter?

- A. They are identical
- B. A parameter doesn't filter data by itself; it provides a value that can be referenced in calculations/filters
- C. Parameters are faster
- D. Filters are parameters

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters are input values; they don't directly filter data but can be used inside calculated fields that do filtering.

Q129: What is a 'dynamic parameter'?

- A. A parameter that changes automatically
- B. A parameter whose list of values updates when the workbook opens (Tableau 2020.1+)
- C. A parameter with a slider
- D. A calculated parameter

Answer: B

Explanation: Dynamic parameters refresh their list of allowable values (e.g., from a field) when the workbook is opened or data refreshes.

Q130: Can a parameter be used in a calculated field?

- A. No
- B. Yes, parameters can be referenced like any field
- C. Only for date calculations
- D. Only with table calculations

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters can be freely referenced in calculated fields, e.g., IF [Sales] > [Sales Threshold Param] THEN 'High' END.

Q131: How do you show a parameter control on a dashboard?

- A. Right-click the parameter > Show Parameter
- B. Drag it from the Data pane
- C. Use the dashboard object menu
- D. Both A and C

Answer: D

Explanation: You can right-click the parameter in the Data pane and choose 'Show Parameter', or add it as a dashboard object.

Q132: What is a common use case for a parameter with a Top N filter?

- A. Color coding
- B. Letting users choose how many top items to display
- C. Date formatting
- D. Text alignment

Answer: B

Explanation: A parameter lets users dynamically change the 'N' value in a Top N filter, customizing how many top results to view.

Q133: Can parameters be used across multiple worksheets?

- A. No, single sheet only
- B. Yes, parameters are workbook-level and can be used in multiple sheets
- C. Only on dashboards
- D. Only with extracts

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters are workbook-scoped and can be referenced by calculated fields and sheets throughout the entire workbook.

Q134: How do you create a parameter that updates based on a field's values?

- A. Set 'Allowable values' to 'When workbook opens' or 'List' sourced from a field
- B. Use 'All' for allowable values
- C. It's not possible
- D. Use a calculated field instead

Answer: A

Explanation: Dynamic parameters can source their list from field values using 'When workbook opens' or sourcing the list from a dimension.

Q135: What does the 'Parameter Action' (introduced in 2019.2+) allow?

- A. Deleting parameters
- B. Changing a parameter's value through user interaction on a viz or dashboard
- C. Exporting parameters
- D. Converting parameters to filters

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameter Actions let dashboard users change a parameter value by clicking/hovering/selecting marks in a visualization.

Q136: What is the main advantage of using parameters for 'What-If' analysis?

- A. No advantage
- B. Users can dynamically change assumptions and see the impact on calculations instantly
- C. Faster performance
- D. Better colors

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters enable what-if scenarios by letting users adjust inputs (e.g., growth rate, discount %) and see results update in real time.

Q137: Can a parameter have a 'Range' of allowable values?

- A. No, only lists
- B. Yes, you can set a range with min, max, and step for numeric parameters
- C. Only for string parameters
- D. Only for date parameters

Answer: B

Explanation: Numeric parameters can be configured with a range (e.g., 0-100 with step 5) with an interactive slider control.

Q138: How do you reference a parameter named 'Growth Rate' in a calculation?

- A. {Growth Rate}
- B. [Growth Rate]
- C. (Growth Rate)
- D. <Growth Rate>

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters are referenced in square brackets in calculations, just like fields: [Growth Rate].

Section 8: Groups & Sets

Q139: What is a 'Group' in Tableau?

- A. A set of dashboards
- B. A user-defined combination of dimension members into a single category
- C. A collection of measures
- D. A type of filter

Answer: B

Explanation: Groups combine multiple dimension values into one category (e.g., grouping states into regions).

Q140: How do you create a group?

- A. Right-click a dimension > Create > Group
- B. In the view, multi-select marks and click the group icon
- C. Both A and B
- D. Use the Analytics pane

Answer: C

Explanation: Groups can be created through the right-click menu on a dimension or by selecting marks in the view.

Q141: What is a 'Set' in Tableau?

- A. A physical collection of data
- B. A custom field defining a subset of data based on conditions or manual selection
- C. A type of chart
- D. A folder for worksheets

Answer: B

Explanation: Sets are custom fields that define IN/OUT members based on conditions, manual selection, or Top N rules.

Q142: What types of Sets can you create?

- A. Fixed Sets and Dynamic Sets
- B. Temporary and Permanent
- C. Local and Global
- D. Text and Number

Answer: A

Explanation: Fixed Sets have static membership; Dynamic Sets recalculate membership based on conditions as data changes.

Q143: How is a 'Combined Set' created?

- A. By merging two data sources
- B. By combining two sets using union, intersection, or difference operations
- C. By grouping sets
- D. Sets cannot be combined

Answer: B

Explanation: Two sets can be combined to create a new set using union (all members), intersection (common), or difference (exclusive).

Q144: What does the 'IN/OUT' designation mean in a Set?

- A. Data is inside or outside a file
- B. Members are either IN (included) or OUT (excluded) of the set
- C. Input/Output operations
- D. Indoor/Outdoor classification

Answer: B

Explanation: Sets work as binary classifiers: each dimension member is either IN the set or OUT, useful for highlighting and filtering.

Q145: Can Sets be used in calculated fields?

- A. No
- B. Yes, sets are Boolean fields usable in calculations
- C. Only Fixed sets
- D. Only Dynamic sets

Answer: B

Explanation: Sets behave as Boolean fields (True/False for IN/OUT) and can be used in any calculated field.

Q146: What is a 'Top N Set'?

- A. A set of the first N records
- B. A dynamic set showing the top (or bottom) N members based on a measure
- C. A fixed set
- D. A group

Answer: B

Explanation: Top N Sets automatically include the top (or bottom) N dimension members ranked by a specified measure.

Q147: How do you use a Set as a filter?

- A. Drag the set to the Filters shelf
- B. Use it in a calculated filter
- C. Both A and B
- D. Sets cannot filter

Answer: C

Explanation: Sets can be dragged directly to Filters (showing IN or OUT) or referenced in calculated fields used for filtering.

Q148: What happens when you use a Set on the Color shelf?

- A. Error
- B. Marks are colored by IN/OUT state, often contrasting members with non-members
- C. Shows only IN members
- D. Nothing

Answer: B

Explanation: Placing a Set on Color highlights IN members in one color and OUT members in another for visual comparison.

Q149: What is the difference between a Group and a Set?

- A. No difference
- B. Groups are for combining values; Sets are for defining subsets (binary IN/OUT)
- C. Groups are dynamic; Sets are static
- D. Groups work on measures; Sets on dimensions

Answer: B

Explanation: Groups merge multiple dimension values into one; Sets define which members are included/excluded (binary logic).

Q150: How do you edit a Set's membership?

- A. Right-click the Set > Edit Set
- B. Double-click the Set
- C. From the Worksheet menu
- D. Both A and B

Answer: D

Explanation: Right-clicking or double-clicking a Set opens the Edit Set dialog to modify conditions or manually adjust membership.

Q151: What is a 'Condition Set'?

- A. A fixed set of conditions
- B. A dynamic set where membership is defined by a condition (e.g., Sales > 100,000)
- C. A set of filters
- D. A parameter

Answer: B

Explanation: Condition Sets use logic (by field, by formula) to dynamically determine which members belong IN the set.

Q152: Can you create a Set from a viz selection?

- A. No
- B. Yes, select marks in the view and click 'Create Set' from the tooltip or right-click menu
- C. Only on dashboards
- D. Only in Tableau Server

Answer: B

Explanation: You can select marks in any visualization, then right-click or use the tooltip to create a set from the selection.

Q153: How do Sets interact with Hierarchies?

- A. Sets break hierarchies
- B. Sets can be defined at any level of a hierarchy
- C. Sets don't work with hierarchies
- D. Sets replace hierarchies

Answer: B

Explanation: Sets work with any dimension regardless of hierarchy level, allowing flexible subset definitions.

Q154: What does 'Use All' vs 'Exclude' mean in a dynamic set?

- A. Use All applies to all sheets; Exclude removes sheets
- B. 'Use All' includes all dimension members until conditions remove them; 'Exclude' removes all until conditions add them
- C. Use All is for measures; Exclude for dimensions
- D. No difference

Answer: B

Explanation: 'Use All' starts with all members and removes those not meeting condition; 'Exclude' starts with none and adds matching members.

Q155: Can Sets be used across multiple worksheets?

- A. No, worksheet-specific only
- B. Yes, sets are part of the data source and available to any sheet using that source
- C. Only on dashboards
- D. Only fixed sets

Answer: B

Explanation: Sets are created at the data source level and can be used across all worksheets connected to that source.

Q156: What is the icon for a Set in the Data pane?

- A. A Venn diagram icon (interlocking circles)
- B. A folder icon
- C. A gear icon
- D. A chain icon

Answer: A

Explanation: Sets are visually distinguished in the Data pane by a Venn diagram icon (two overlapping circles).

Section 9: Dashboards & Stories

Q157: What is a Tableau Dashboard?

- A. A single chart
- B. A collection of multiple worksheets and objects on a single interactive page
- C. A data source
- D. A report in PDF

Answer: B

Explanation: A Dashboard combines multiple sheets, filters, images, and objects into one interactive view/page.

Q158: How do you add a worksheet to a dashboard?

- A. Drag the worksheet from the Sheets list onto the dashboard canvas
- B. Right-click and select Add
- C. Use the Dashboard menu
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: Worksheets can be added by dragging from the sheet list, right-click menu, or Dashboard menu > Add Sheet.

Q159: What is a 'Dashboard Action'?

- A. A keyboard shortcut
- B. An interactive behavior (Filter, Highlight, URL) triggered by user interaction
- C. A database trigger
- D. A scheduled refresh

Answer: B

Explanation: Dashboard Actions add interactivity: Filter Actions (click to filter), Highlight Actions (hover to highlight), and URL Actions (click to navigate).

Q160: What are the three types of Dashboard Actions?

- A. Filter, Highlight, URL
- B. Sort, Filter, Color
- C. Display, Hide, Resize
- D. Click, Hover, Select

Answer: A

Explanation: The three action types are: Filter (filter other sheets), Highlight (emphasize related marks), and URL (navigate to web links).

Q161: What is a 'Floating' vs 'Tiled' dashboard object?

- A. Floating can be freely positioned; Tiled snaps to a grid layout
- B. Floating is on top; Tiled is behind
- C. Floating is for images; Tiled is for sheets
- D. No difference

Answer: A

Explanation: Floating objects have pixel-level positioning; Tiled objects auto-arrange in a responsive grid.

Q162: What is the purpose of a 'Layout Container'?

- A. To store data
- B. To group and organize dashboard objects with consistent formatting/layout
- C. To hold filters only
- D. To contain extract files

Answer: B

Explanation: Layout containers (horizontal/vertical) help organize multiple dashboard objects, maintaining alignment and responsive behavior.

Q163: How do you make a dashboard filter apply to specific sheets only?

- A. Not possible
- B. Use the filter's dropdown > 'Apply to Worksheets' > select specific sheets
- C. Create separate filters for each sheet
- D. Use a parameter

Answer: B

Explanation: Dashboard filter cards can be configured to apply to all sheets using the same data source or only selected sheets.

Q164: What is a 'Story' in Tableau?

- A. A single dashboard
- B. A sequence of dashboards/worksheets presented as a narrative with captions
- C. A data source narrative
- D. A type of chart

Answer: B

Explanation: Stories are sequential narratives built from dashboards and worksheets, ideal for guided presentations.

Q165: What are 'Story Points'?

- A. Key data points in a chart
- B. Individual slides/pages within a Story
- C. Plot points on a map
- D. Sales milestones

Answer: B

Explanation: Story Points are the individual frames (like slides) that make up a Tableau Story.

Q166: How do you add a caption to a Story Point?

- A. Use the 'Add a caption' text box in the Story workspace
- B. Use a text object
- C. Use a tooltip
- D. Not possible

Answer: A

Explanation: Each Story Point has a dedicated narration/caption box for adding descriptive text.

Q167: What is 'Device Designer' in Tableau dashboards?

- A. A tool to create mobile apps
- B. A feature to customize dashboard layouts for different device types (desktop, tablet, phone)
- C. A designer for hardware devices
- D. A chart designer

Answer: B

Explanation: Device Designer lets you create device-specific dashboard layouts with different sizing and content for each device type.

Q168: How do you add a web page to a dashboard?

- A. Not possible
- B. Use the 'Web Page' dashboard object and enter the URL
- C. Use a URL action
- D. Only via API

Answer: B

Explanation: The 'Web Page' object allows embedding external web pages directly into a Tableau dashboard.

Q169: What is a 'Zone' in a Tableau dashboard?

- A. A geographic region
- B. Any area/object on the dashboard canvas (each sheet, filter, text box is a zone)
- C. A time zone setting
- D. A data zone

Answer: B

Explanation: Every item placed on a dashboard (sheets, filters, text, images) occupies a 'zone' with its own layout settings.

Q170: How do you add an image to a dashboard?

- A. Not supported
- B. Use the 'Image' dashboard object and browse/insert
- C. Only via URL
- D. Only through extensions

Answer: B

Explanation: The Image dashboard object lets you insert static images (logos, icons) into dashboards.

Q171: What happens when you remove a worksheet from a dashboard?

- A. The worksheet is deleted
- B. The worksheet is removed from the dashboard but remains in the workbook
- C. The data source is deleted
- D. Nothing

Answer: B

Explanation: Removing a worksheet from a dashboard only detaches it; the underlying sheet persists in the workbook.

Q172: How do you set up a Filter Action?

- A. From Dashboard menu > Actions > Add Action > Filter
- B. Right-click a sheet on the dashboard > Use as Filter
- C. Both A and B
- D. It's automatic

Answer: C

Explanation: Filter actions can be configured through Actions dialog (Dashboard > Actions) or by right-clicking a sheet and selecting 'Use as Filter'.

Q173: What is the 'Show dashboard title' option?

- A. Shows the dashboard name at the top
- B. Shows a title on every sheet
- C. Shows axis titles
- D. Shows filter titles

Answer: A

Explanation: Enabling 'Show dashboard title' displays the dashboard name as a formatted title at the top of the dashboard.

Q174: How can you fit a dashboard to the screen size?

- A. Set Size to 'Automatic'
- B. Use 'Fit Width' or 'Fit Height'
- C. Set a fixed size matching the screen
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: Dashboard sizing options include Automatic (adapts), Range, Fixed Size, or published size matching.

Q175: What does the 'Export Image' option do?

- A. Exports data
- B. Creates a PNG/BMP/JPEG image of the current view or dashboard
- C. Exports to PDF
- D. Sends to printer

Answer: B

Explanation: Export Image saves a static image snapshot of the current worksheet or dashboard.

Section 10: Maps & Geospatial Analysis

Q176: What is required to create a map in Tableau?

- A. A date field
- B. A field with a geographic role assigned (e.g., Country, City, Latitude/Longitude)
- C. A measure only
- D. A calculated field

Answer: B

Explanation: Maps require geographic fields with assigned roles (Country, State, City, Zip, or explicit Lat/Long).

Q177: How does Tableau recognize geographic roles?

- A. Manually entered
- B. Built-in geocoding database matches field names and values
- C. Through a web service only
- D. It doesn't

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau has internal geocoding that matches recognized geographic names to latitude/longitude coordinates.

Q178: What is a 'Filled Map'?

- A. A map with filled shapes
- B. A choropleth map where geographic areas are colored by a measure
- C. A map with no data
- D. A background image

Answer: B

Explanation: Filled maps (choropleth) color entire geographic regions (countries, states) by measure magnitude.

Q179: What is a 'Symbol Map'?

- A. A map with symbols instead of data
- B. A map showing marks (circles, shapes) at geographic locations sized/colored by measures
- C. A map legend
- D. A map key

Answer: B

Explanation: Symbol maps place proportional marks at geographic coordinates, with size and color conveying measure values.

Q180: How do you create a dual-axis map (layered maps)?

- A. Not possible
- B. Use two sets of geographic fields or duplicate latitude, then dual axis
- C. Use Show Me
- D. Only with custom geocoding

Answer: B

Explanation: Dual-axis maps layer two map layers (e.g., filled state map + symbol city map) using dual axis on the longitude field.

Q181: What is a 'Density Map'?

- A. A map with high data volume
- B. A heat map showing concentration of data points using color intensity
- C. A map showing population
- D. A topographic map

Answer: B

Explanation: Density maps (heat maps) visualize point concentration through color intensity, useful when many overlapping marks exist.

Q182: How do you use custom geocoding in Tableau?

- A. Import custom .csv with geographic roles
- B. Use the built-in geocoding only
- C. Custom geocoding not supported
- D. Only via API

Answer: A

Explanation: Custom .csv files with geographic names and lat/long coordinates can be imported via Map > Geocoding > Import Custom Geocoding.

Q183: What are 'Background Images' used for in Tableau maps?

- A. Making maps look nicer
- B. Overlaying custom floor plans, stadium layouts, or non-standard maps with coordinate data
- C. Adding photos to dashboards
- D. Not related to maps

Answer: B

Explanation: Background images with mapped X/Y coordinates let you create custom spatial views like store floor plans or stadium views.

Q184: What is a 'Spatial File' connection?

- A. A text file
- B. Connection to .shp, .kml, .geoJSON files containing geographic shapes
- C. An image file
- D. A database connection

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau supports direct connection to spatial files (Shapefiles, KML, GeoJSON) for custom geographic boundaries.

Q185: How do you fix an 'Unknown' geographic location in Tableau?

- A. Ignore it
- B. Edit Locations to manually match or assign coordinates
- C. Delete the data
- D. Restart Tableau

Answer: B

Explanation: The 'Edit Locations' dialog (Map > Edit Locations) lets you manually match unrecognized geographic names to known locations.

Q186: What is the role of 'Generated Latitude' and 'Generated Longitude' fields?

- A. User-created fields
- B. Auto-generated fields from geographic role assignment, used for plotting on maps
- C. Calculated fields
- D. Parameters

Answer: B

Explanation: When a geographic role is assigned, Tableau generates Latitude (generated) and Longitude (generated) fields behind the scenes.

Q187: How do you add map layers (e.g., streets, satellite)?

- A. File > Map Options
- B. Map > Background Maps > select style
- C. Right-click the map > Background Layers
- D. Both B and C

Answer: D

Explanation: Map background styles (Streets, Satellite, Outdoors, etc.) can be changed via Map menu or right-click Background Layers on the map.

Q188: What does the 'Buffer' spatial calculation do?

- A. Speeds up maps
- B. Creates a radius/distance zone around a point or shape
- C. Reduces map detail
- D. Buffers data loading

Answer: B

Explanation: BUFFER() creates a circular zone around a spatial point or expanded boundary around a shape at a specified distance.

Q189: Can Tableau perform spatial joins?

- A. No
- B. Yes, using spatial relationships like Intersects, Contains, Within
- C. Only with databases
- D. Only in Tableau Prep

Answer: B

Explanation: Spatial joins (Intersects, Contains, Within, Distance) are supported to combine data based on geographic relationships.

Section 11: Level of Detail (LOD) Expressions

Q190: What does LOD stand for in Tableau?

- A. Level of Design
- B. Level of Detail
- C. Length of Data
- D. Line of Dimension

Answer: B

Explanation: LOD (Level of Detail) expressions control the granularity at which aggregations are computed, independent of the view.

Q191: What are the three types of LOD expressions?

- A. FIXED, INCLUDE, EXCLUDE
- B. SUM, AVG, COUNT
- C. HIGH, MEDIUM, LOW
- D. ROW, COLUMN, PAGE

Answer: A

Explanation: The three LOD keywords are: FIXED (compute at specified dimension), INCLUDE (add dimensions), and EXCLUDE (remove dimensions).

Q192: What does a FIXED LOD expression do?

- A. Fixes broken calculations
- B. Computes values at a specified dimension level regardless of view dimensions
- C. Locks filters
- D. Creates fixed-width files

Answer: B

Explanation: FIXED LODs calculate at the exact dimension(s) specified, ignoring any dimensions in the view besides those listed.

Q193: What is the syntax for a FIXED LOD?

- A. {FIXED [Dimension] : AGG([Measure])}
- B. [FIXED [Dimension] : AGG([Measure])]
- C. (FIXED [Dimension] : AGG([Measure]))
- D. FIXED([Dimension], AGG([Measure]))

Answer: A

Explanation: LOD expressions use curly braces: {FIXED [Region] : SUM([Sales])}.

Q194: How does INCLUDE LOD differ from FIXED?

- A. No difference
- B. INCLUDE adds dimensions to the view's level; FIXED uses only specified dimensions
- C. INCLUDE is slower
- D. INCLUDE works only with dates

Answer: B

Explanation: INCLUDE adds extra dimensions to the view's current detail level; FIXED completely overrides the view's dimensions.

Q195: When would you use an EXCLUDE LOD?

- A. To add dimensions
- B. To remove a dimension from the aggregation level (compute at a coarser grain)
- C. To exclude data
- D. To delete fields

Answer: B

Explanation: EXCLUDE removes a view dimension from the aggregation, allowing coarser-grained calculations like per-category averages in a sub-category view.

Q196: What is a common use case for FIXED LOD?

- A. Date formatting
- B. Customer cohort analysis (e.g., first purchase date per customer)
- C. Text labels
- D. Color assignment

Answer: B

Explanation: FIXED [Customer ID] : MIN([Order Date]) returns each customer's first order date regardless of the view's date context.

Q197: Where are LOD expressions evaluated in the order of operations?

- A. Before extract filters
- B. After dimension filters, before measure filters
- C. After all filters
- D. Before any filters

Answer: B

Explanation: FIXED LODs evaluate after context filters but before dimension filters; INCLUDE/EXCLUDE evaluate after dimension filters.

Q198: Can you use LOD expressions with table calculations?

- A. No
- B. Yes, LOD results can be further used in table calculations
- C. Only FIXED
- D. Only EXCLUDE

Answer: B

Explanation: LOD expressions return aggregate values that can be used as inputs to table calculations.

Q199: What does this FIXED LOD compute: {FIXED [State] : SUM([Sales])}?

- A. Total sales for the entire dataset
- B. Total sales per state, regardless of other dimensions in the view
- C. Average sales per state
- D. Sales per city

Answer: B

Explanation: This FIXED LOD returns the total sales for each state independently, no matter what other dimensions are in the view.

Q200: What happens to FIXED LOD when a dimension filter is applied?

- A. The FIXED LOD is filtered
- B. FIXED LODs ignore dimension filters by default (unless context filter)
- C. The LOD breaks
- D. It creates an error

Answer: B

Explanation: FIXED LODs are computed before dimension filters; only context filters and data source filters affect them.

Q201: How do INCLUDE and EXCLUDE LODs interact with filters?

- A. They ignore all filters
- B. They respect all filters in the view
- C. Only context filters
- D. Only extract filters

Answer: B

Explanation: INCLUDE and EXCLUDE LODs respect all filters currently applied in the view since they compute after dimension filters.

Q202: What is the result of: {EXCLUDE [Region] : SUM([Sales])}?

- A. Sales grouped by Region
- B. Sales at all dimensions except Region (ignoring Region grouping)
- C. Global total sales only
- D. Error

Answer: B

Explanation: EXCLUDE [Region] means calculate SUM(Sales) as if Region is not in the view, effectively giving higher-level aggregates.

Q203: Which LOD type would you use to calculate 'Total Company Sales' alongside regional sales?

- A. FIXED
- B. {SUM([Sales])}
- C. FIXED with no dimensions: {SUM([Sales])}
- D. Both A and C

Answer: D

Explanation: Both {SUM([Sales])} (FIXED with no dimensions) and {FIXED : SUM([Sales])} return the grand total across the entire dataset.

Q204: Can LOD expressions reference parameters?

- A. No
- B. Yes, parameters can be used inside LOD expressions
- C. Only in FIXED
- D. Only in INCLUDE

Answer: B

Explanation: Parameters can be referenced within LOD expressions just like any other field, enabling dynamic LOD calculations.

Q205: What is 'Nested LOD'?

- A. Multiple LODs in one field
- B. One LOD expression used inside another LOD expression
- C. LOD inside a table calc
- D. Both A and B

Answer: D

Explanation: LODs can be nested (one inside another) and can be used inside table calculations for complex multi-level analysis.

Section 12: Table Calculations

Q206: What is a Table Calculation?

- A. A SQL query
- B. A calculation performed on the aggregated result set in the view
- C. A row-level calculation
- D. An extract calculation

Answer: B

Explanation: Table calculations operate on the already-aggregated results displayed in the view, not on the underlying data.

Q207: Which of these is a Table Calculation function?

- A. SUM()
- B. RUNNING_SUM()
- C. COUNTD()
- D. AVG()

Answer: B

Explanation: RUNNING_SUM() is a table calculation; SUM(), COUNTD(), and AVG() are standard aggregate functions.

Q208: What is 'Compute Using' in Table Calculations?

- A. Specifies which computer to use
- B. Defines the direction and scope of the table calculation (Table, Pane, Cell, or Specific Dimensions)
- C. Selects data sources
- D. Chooses calculation type

Answer: B

Explanation: Compute Using determines how the table calculation traverses the result set: across, down, table, pane, cell, or specific dimensions.

Q209: What does RUNNING_SUM() do?

- A. Sums all values
- B. Calculates a cumulative sum that adds each value to the running total
- C. Sums only positive values
- D. Sums distinct values

Answer: B

Explanation: RUNNING_SUM(SUM([Sales])) produces a cumulative total, adding each subsequent value to the previous running total.

Q210: What is the difference between RUNNING_SUM() and WINDOW_SUM()?

- A. No difference
- B. RUNNING_SUM is cumulative from the first row; WINDOW_SUM sums a specified window range
- C. WINDOW_SUM is faster
- D. RUNNING_SUM only works on dates

Answer: B

Explanation: RUNNING_SUM always accumulates all previous values; WINDOW_SUM can target a sliding window (e.g., last 3 months).

Q211: What does LOOKUP() do?

- A. Finds a value in the data
- B. Returns the value of an expression at a specified offset from the current row
- C. Searches for text
- D. Queries a database

Answer: B

Explanation: LOOKUP(SUM([Sales]), -1) returns the Sales value from the previous row; an offset of 0 is the current row.

Q212: What is 'Percent of Total' achieved through?

- A. A standard aggregate
- B. A Quick Table Calculation on a measure
- C. A LOD expression
- D. A parameter

Answer: B

Explanation: Percent of Total is a built-in Quick Table Calculation option available by right-clicking a measure and selecting Quick Table Calculation.

Q213: What are the 'Addressing' vs 'Partitioning' fields in a table calculation?

- A. Addressing = direction of computation; Partitioning = grouping for restart
- B. Addressing = filtering; Partitioning = sorting
- C. They are the same
- D. Addressing = columns; Partitioning = rows

Answer: A

Explanation: Addressing defines the order/direction the calc moves through; Partitioning defines where the calc resets/restarts.

Q214: What does TOTAL() do?

- A. Same as SUM()
- B. Returns the total across the entire addressing scope (table/partition)
- C. Counts all values
- D. Finds the maximum

Answer: B

Explanation: TOTAL(SUM([Sales])) returns the total sum across all rows in the partition, not per-row.

Q215: How do you change the scope of a table calculation?

- A. Edit Table Calculation > Specific Dimensions
- B. Re-run the extract
- C. Change the data source
- D. It's fixed

Answer: A

Explanation: The 'Edit Table Calculation' dialog allows you to select specific dimensions or change compute direction.

Q216: What does FIRST() return?

- A. The first row's value
- B. The offset from the current row to the first row of the partition
- C. The first date
- D. The alphabetically first value

Answer: B

Explanation: FIRST() returns the number of steps (offset) from the current row to the first row of the partition (0 at first row).

Q217: What does LAST() return?

- A. The last row's value
- B. The offset from the current row to the last row of the partition
- C. The most recent date
- D. The last character

Answer: B

Explanation: LAST() returns the offset from the current row to the last row (0 at last row, negative values elsewhere).

Q218: What is a 'Secondary Calculation' in Tableau?

- A. A second calculation on the same measure
- B. Applying an additional table calculation on top of another (e.g., Running Sum of Percent of Total)
- C. A calculation on a different data source
- D. A backup calculation

Answer: B

Explanation: Secondary table calculations nest one table calculation inside another, like running total of percent difference.

Q219: What does SIZE() return?

- A. The number of bytes
- B. The number of rows in the current partition
- C. The width of columns
- D. The size of the data source

Answer: B

Explanation: SIZE() returns the total number of rows in the partition, useful for computing percentages manually.

Q220: How do you compute a 'Moving Average' in Tableau?

- A. Use AVG()
- B. Use WINDOW_AVG() with a window range
- C. Use MOVING_AVG()
- D. Both B and C

Answer: D

Explanation: WINDOW_AVG(SUM([Sales]), -2, 0) computes a moving average; Tableau also offers Moving Average as a Quick Table Calc.

Q221: What is the 'Rank' table calculation?

- A. Sorts data
- B. Assigns a rank (1, 2, 3...) to each row based on a measure value
- C. Filters top values
- D. Creates groups

Answer: B

Explanation: RANK(SUM([Sales])) assigns a rank to each item; RANK_DENSE handles ties differently.

Q222: What does PREVIOUS_VALUE() do?

- A. Returns the original value
- B. Returns the value of this calculation from the previous row
- C. Returns NULL
- D. Returns the first value

Answer: B

Explanation: PREVIOUS_VALUE() is a self-referencing table calculation that returns its own result from the preceding row.

Section 13: Formatting & Annotations

Q223: How do you format numbers in Tableau (e.g., currency, percentage)?

- A. Right-click the measure > Format > Numbers
- B. Use the Format menu > Format > Fields
- C. Use a calculated field
- D. Both A and B

Answer: D

Explanation: Number formatting can be set via right-click Format or through the Format menu for fields, axes, and pane.

Q224: What is an 'Annotation' in Tableau?

- A. A SQL comment
- B. A text note attached to a specific point, mark, or area in the view
- C. A type of filter
- D. A data label

Answer: B

Explanation: Annotations add descriptive text to specific marks (Point), the entire view (Area), or a data point (Mark).

Q225: How do you add an annotation to a specific data point?

- A. Right-click the mark > Annotate > Mark
- B. Use the Analysis menu
- C. Type directly on the chart
- D. Use a text object

Answer: A

Explanation: Right-clicking a mark and selecting Annotate > Mark adds a text annotation anchored to that specific data point.

Q226: What does 'Format Paintbrush' do?

- A. Paints the canvas
- B. Copies formatting from one element and applies it to another
- C. Colors charts
- D. Creates gradients

Answer: B

Explanation: The Format Painter copies formatting (fonts, colors, borders) from one worksheet/dashboard element to another.

Q227: How do you change the color palette of a chart?

- A. Edit Colors on the Marks card or legend
- B. Use the Format menu
- C. Right-click the color legend > Edit Colors
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: Colors can be changed via the Marks card, Format menu, color legend, or by double-clicking the legend.

Q228: What is 'Shading' in Tableau formatting?

- A. Drop shadows
- B. Background color formatting for worksheet panes, headers, and cells
- C. 3D effects
- D. Gradient fills

Answer: B

Explanation: Shading refers to background color formatting for various areas: worksheet, pane, headers, and totals.

Q229: How do you hide a field label (header) in the view?

- A. Right-click the header > Hide Field Labels for Rows/Columns
- B. Delete the field
- C. Use a filter
- D. Not possible

Answer: A

Explanation: Right-clicking a row/column header and selecting 'Hide Field Labels' removes the header text from the view.

Q230: What does 'Band Lines' formatting do?

- A. Adds musical notes
- B. Creates alternating shaded bands in tables/crosstabs for readability
- C. Adds border bands
- D. Creates reference bands

Answer: B

Explanation: Band lines/banding adds alternating row/column shading (like zebra striping) to improve readability in text tables.

Q231: How do you edit a tooltip?

- A. Click Tooltip on the Marks card
- B. Drag fields to the Tooltip shelf
- C. Use the Worksheet menu > Tooltip
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: Tooltips can be edited via the Tooltip button on the Marks card, by dragging fields to Tooltip, or through the Worksheet menu.

Q232: What can be included in a Tableau tooltip?

- A. Text only
- B. Text, field values, and even other visualizations (Viz in Tooltip)
- C. Only numbers
- D. Only field names

Answer: B

Explanation: Tooltips support rich text, dynamic field values, and even embedded sheet visualizations (Viz in Tooltip feature).

Q233: How do you align text in a worksheet title?

- A. Double-click the title to edit; use toolbar alignment buttons
- B. Right-click > Format
- C. Use the Marks card
- D. Both A and B

Answer: D

Explanation: Titles can be edited and formatted via double-click (rich text editor) or right-click Format Title for more options.

Q234: What is the purpose of 'Legends' in Tableau?

- A. To tell stories
- B. To map colors, sizes, and shapes to data values
- C. To list data sources
- D. To show SQL queries

Answer: B

Explanation: Legends explain the encoding: what colors represent which dimension values or how size maps to measure magnitude.

Q235: How do you resize a chart within a dashboard?

- A. Drag the edges of the container
- B. Use the Layout pane to set pixel size
- C. Use the 'Fit' options
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Explanation: Charts can be resized by dragging container edges, setting exact pixel dimensions in Layout, or using fit presets.

Section 14: Publishing, Sharing & Permissions

Q236: How do you publish a workbook to Tableau Server?

- A. File > Save
- B. Server > Publish Workbook
- C. Export as PDF
- D. Share via email

Answer: B

Explanation: Workbooks are published via Server > Publish Workbook (or Tableau Public > Save to Tableau Public).

Q237: What is Tableau Public?

- A. The same as Tableau Desktop
- B. A free platform for publishing interactive visualizations publicly online
- C. A private server
- D. A data storage service

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Public is a free hosting service where anyone can publish and share interactive data visualizations publicly.

Q238: What permissions can be set on Tableau Server for a workbook?

- A. View, Filter, Download, Web Edit, etc.
- B. Only View
- C. Only Edit
- D. No permissions needed

Answer: A

Explanation: Tableau Server offers granular permissions: View, Filter, Download Data, Web Edit, Download Workbook, and more.

Q239: What is a 'Packaged Workbook' (.twbx)?

- A. A workbook with only the structure
- B. A workbook that includes the data along with the visualization
- C. A partial workbook
- D. An image file

Answer: B

Explanation: .twbx files contain both the workbook structure and the underlying data (extract or file data), making them portable.

Q240: How do you schedule an extract refresh on Tableau Server?

- A. Manually every time
- B. Use Tableau Server's scheduled tasks or Tableau Bridge for on-prem data
- C. Extracts refresh automatically
- D. Only via command line

Answer: B

Explanation: Extract refreshes can be scheduled on Tableau Server (or via Tableau Bridge for on-premises data sources).

Q241: What is Tableau Bridge?

- A. A connector cable
- B. A client software that maintains live/refresh connections between on-premises data and Tableau Cloud
- C. A network device
- D. A database driver

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Bridge enables Tableau Cloud to connect to and refresh data from on-premises/private network sources.

Q242: Can you export a Tableau dashboard to PDF?

- A. No
- B. Yes, File > Print to PDF or Dashboard > Export to PDF
- C. Only worksheets
- D. Only images

Answer: B

Explanation: Dashboards and worksheets can be exported to PDF via the File menu (Print to PDF) or dashboard export options.

Q243: What are 'Subscriptions' in Tableau Server/Cloud?

- A. Paid features
- B. Automated scheduled email delivery of workbook snapshots to users
- C. RSS feeds
- D. Newsletter signups

Answer: B

Explanation: Subscriptions allow users to receive scheduled email snapshots or PDF exports of dashboards/views.

Q244: What is a 'Data Source Certification'?

- A. A validation stamp
- B. An endorsement marking a data source as trusted/recommended by administrators
- C. A backup copy
- D. A performance rating

Answer: B

Explanation: Data source certification lets administrators mark authoritative data sources with a 'Certified' badge for user trust.

Q245: How can users comment on a view in Tableau Server/Cloud?

- A. Not possible
- B. Use the Comments panel/sidebar on published views
- C. Via email
- D. Through the API

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Server and Cloud include a Comments feature allowing threaded discussions directly on published views.

Section 15: Performance Optimization & Best Practices

Q246: What is the most effective way to improve Tableau workbook performance?

- A. Use more data
- B. Use extracts instead of live connections when possible
- C. Add more calculations
- D. Use only text tables

Answer: B

Explanation: Extracts (.hyper) are optimized for fast query performance compared to live connections to databases.

Q247: What does the 'Performance Recorder' do in Tableau?

- A. Records screen activity
- B. Logs query timing and rendering events to help diagnose performance bottlenecks
- C. Records user actions
- D. Creates performance charts

Answer: B

Explanation: The Performance Recorder (Help > Settings and Performance > Start Performance Recording) captures timing data for analysis.

Q248: What is 'Data Source Filter' vs 'Extract Filter' for performance?

- A. No difference
- B. Data source filters apply to all queries; extract filters reduce extract size
- C. Extract filters are slower
- D. Data source filters are faster

Answer: B

Explanation: Data Source Filters reduce data at the connection level; Extract Filters reduce what's stored in the extract, both improving performance.

Q249: What is a general best practice for calculated fields?

- A. Use as many as possible
- B. Minimize row-level calculations; prefer database-level calculations or extracts
- C. Avoid all calculations
- D. Only use table calculations

Answer: B

Explanation: Row-level calculations in Tableau are computed locally; pushing complex logic to the database or extract is more efficient.

Q250: What is 'Context Filter' performance impact?

- A. None
- B. Context filters create a temporary table; useful for Top N but can slow if too large
- C. Always speeds up
- D. Not relevant

Answer: B

Explanation: Context filters create a temp table used by other filters; they can improve or degrade performance depending on size and use case.

Q251: How do you reduce the size of a Tableau extract?

- A. Cannot be reduced
- B. Use extract filters, hide unused fields, and aggregate data for visible dimensions
- C. Add more data
- D. Convert to .tde

Answer: B

Explanation: Extract size can be minimized by filtering rows, hiding unused columns, and aggregating to needed detail levels.

Q252: What does 'Aggregate to visible dimensions' mean in extracts?

- A. Show all data
- B. Roll up data to only the granularity of dimensions visible in the view
- C. Increase detail
- D. Delete data

Answer: B

Explanation: This option pre-aggregates data in the extract to the level of detail needed by the views, greatly reducing extract size.

Q253: What is a 'Materialized Calculation'?

- A. A temporary field
- B. A calculated field pre-computed and stored in the extract
- C. A table calculation
- D. A live calculation

Answer: B

Explanation: Materialized calculations are computed once during extract creation and stored, avoiding re-computation during queries.

Q254: What is the recommended color palette for accessibility?

- A. Any colors
- B. Color-blind safe palettes (e.g., Tableau's built-in accessibility palettes)
- C. Only grayscale
- D. Bright neon colors

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau provides built-in color-blind safe palettes to ensure visualizations are accessible to all users.

Q255: What should you consider when designing dashboards for mobile?

- A. Nothing special
- B. Use Device Designer for mobile layouts; simplify content; use larger touch targets
- C. Use the same layout
- D. Mobile isn't supported

Answer: B

Explanation: Device Designer allows mobile-specific dashboard layouts; simplified views with larger touch targets improve mobile UX.

Q256: What is the benefit of using 'Relationships' over 'Joins'?

- A. No benefit
- B. Relationships are more flexible; Tableau optimizes queries by selecting appropriate joins at runtime
- C. Joins are always better
- D. Relationships are for visuals only

Answer: B

Explanation: Relationships provide a semantic layer where Tableau automatically picks the right join type based on the visualization context.

Q257: How do you identify slow-performing workbooks?

- A. Guesswork
- B. Use Performance Recorder and Tableau Server's Admin Insights/Performance views
- C. Check file size only
- D. Ask users

Answer: B

Explanation: Performance Recorder in Desktop and Admin Insights on Server help identify slow queries, rendering times, and bottlenecks.

Section 16: Advanced Concepts & Miscellaneous

Q258: What is 'Ask Data' in Tableau?

- A. A support chat
- B. A natural language querying feature that lets users type questions to generate visualizations
- C. A survey tool
- D. A data dictionary

Answer: B

Explanation: Ask Data enables users to type natural language questions (e.g., 'sales by region in 2023') and auto-generates visualizations.

Q259: What are 'Tableau Extensions'?

- A. File extensions
- B. Third-party web applications that integrate into Tableau dashboards for added functionality
- C. Data source extensions
- D. Calculated field types

Answer: B

Explanation: Dashboard Extensions allow embedding interactive web apps within Tableau dashboards for advanced features.

Q260: What is the 'Explain Data' feature?

- A. Documents data sources
- B. AI-powered feature that analyzes a selected mark and provides explanations for its value
- C. A tutorial mode
- D. Data documentation

Answer: B

Explanation: Explain Data uses AI/ML to identify what makes a selected data point unusual, analyzing potential contributing factors.

Q261: What is 'Data Guide' in Tableau?

- A. A navigation guide
- B. An auto-generated documentation panel showing data source and field information
- C. A tutorial
- D. A help file

Answer: B

Explanation: The Data Guide provides on-the-fly documentation about the workbook's data sources, fields, and calculations.

Q262: What is a 'Tableau Accelerator'?

- A. A speed booster
- B. Pre-built dashboards for specific industries/use cases that jumpstart analysis
- C. A performance tool
- D. A hardware device

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Accelerators are ready-made, customizable dashboard templates designed for common business scenarios.

Q263: What is 'Viz Animations' in Tableau?

- A. Cartoon effects
- B. Smooth transitions when data changes (filtering, sorting) for better user experience
- C. Loading animations
- D. Export animations

Answer: B

Explanation: Viz Animations provide smooth visual transitions when filters, sorting, or data changes occur, helping users track changes.

Q264: Can Tableau connect to Python/R for advanced analytics?

- A. No
- B. Yes, through TabPy (Tableau Python Server) and Rserve integrations
- C. Only Python
- D. Only in Tableau Public

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau integrates with Python via TabPy and R via Rserve for advanced statistical and machine learning calculations.

Q265: What is 'Dynamic Zone Visibility' (introduced 2022.3+)?

- A. Animations
- B. Showing or hiding dashboard zones based on parameter values or conditions
- C. Color changes
- D. Filter behavior

Answer: B

Explanation: Dynamic Zone Visibility lets dashboard elements appear/disappear based on parameter values or field conditions.

Q266: What is a 'Tableau Blueprint'?

- A. A color scheme
- B. A methodology/framework for building a data-driven organization with Tableau
- C. A dashboard template
- D. A server configuration

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Blueprint is a strategic framework providing best practices for deploying, adopting, and scaling Tableau.

Q267: How does Tableau handle version control?

- A. No version control
- B. Workbook revisions on Server, and integration with external version control systems
- C. Only manual backups
- D. Through Excel

Answer: B

Explanation: Tableau Server/Cloud maintains workbook revisions; also integrates with Git/SVN through Tableau's REST API and developer tools.